Faculty of Science

Format and layout of the Master's thesis

Cover Page of the Master's Thesis

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This template does not apply in the case of dual degrees (Geography, Tourism). These programs provide their own customized cover page.

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Substantive Formatting of the Master's Thesis

Popularising Summary

A page with a popularising summary of the master's thesis must be included, written in a way that is understandable to a broad audience and in the language of the thesis. This summary will be uploaded via a mandatory field in the metadata form and does not need to be included in the thesis itself. The length of the summary is limited to one A4 page (3500 characters) and should be submitted without formatting.

Substantive Formatting of the Master's Thesis

The master's thesis must be consistent with respect to bibliography and references. At the end of the thesis, a comprehensive list of bibliographic references must be provided. References to figures, tables, and appendices should also be consistent.

The following items are included in the master's thesis:

- **Foreword:** This should summarize the general purpose of the work. Additionally, everyone who contributed should be thanked here.
- **Contribution Statement (depending on the program):** This section of the thesis should indicate the individual contribution and any support and contributions provided by others, such as the

supervisor(s), daily advisor, fellow student, etc. Learn more about the contribution statement here.

- **Short Summary** (max. 2 pages per language): This should summarize the main objectives and conclusions of the master's thesis, in Dutch and English for a Dutch-language master's program, and only in English for an English-language master's program.
- **List of Abbreviations and List of Symbols:** This should include the main abbreviations and symbols used in the thesis, along with their meanings and units.
- **Content:** An overview of the content should be provided with references to the correct page numbers (maximum of three sub-levels). All pages before Chapter 1 should be numbered with Roman numerals (I, II, …). From Chapter 1 onward, numbering should be with Arabic numerals (1, 2, …).
- The **chapters** should include:
  - A detailed introduction that, in addition to outlining the approach and methods used, places the research in a broader context.
  - Results and discussion of the research.
  - A conclusion, which should include a general discussion of the research results. Suggestions for future research can also be included.
  - **Appendices:** These should include parts of the research that are essential but would detract from the readability of the text, such as lengthy mathematical derivations, experimental data, examples, figures, etc.

The **font** should always be one from the Helvetica Neue or Arial family, as prescribed by the KU Leuven house style. If you wish to work in LaTeX, you can use the template for doctoral theses from the Arenberg Doctoral School.

Submitting the Master's Thesis

The master's thesis must be **submitted electronically** via KU Loket: workflow for submitting and archiving electronic master's thesis.

Printing is no longer required.

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Reacties op inhoud en toegankelijkheid: Faculteit Wetenschappen KU Leuven

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